Alex Siebenaler

Why Honors Essay

08/25/2026

HONR 375

Why Honors?

There are so many reasons why I joined the honors program, like pushing myself, to have something more challenging, because my dad wanted me, to help with my resume, you name it the list could go on forever. The reasons why I decided to stay in this program, however, are far different after taking time to reflect on my first semester in honors. The main reason, I would say, is just that, reflection.

Reflection is one of the most important parts of growth in my opinion, and I have always overlooked this aspect of my life. Getting caught up in doing things for growth, like in my experiences have been internships, working with non-profits, starting my own business, you name it has always been beneficial to me but lack true growth without reflection. The aspect of sitting down and working through some of the things you do in life and experiences you have helped you understand how you developed as a person through them. Honors 201 really helped me understand the importance of reflection.

During the duration of my first semester in honors, we really took time reflecting on who we are as people and forced deeper thoughts about oneself. With this, my participation in honors has helped me take what I learned about reflection and grow in other experiences I have had at MNSU. One big example I can think of was my time in the IBE, or Integrated Business Experience. I was the CEO of COREMOTION, a brand who sold products to help

support mental and physical health. We were able to donate of 3,000$ in 8 weeks to a trauma foundation which I was super proud to be a part of. This was the smallest donation from any of the companies. That was a little bit demeaning to hear at the end of the semester after all the hard work that I had put in for the semester. After this I did a lot of self-reflection, and was able to take a lot more out of it than the amount of money we donated. Everyone's who experiences things, even the same exact things, can get different things out of it. I feel like I was able to realize way more things that I had learned, developed, and grew from this experience than some of the people who donated thousands of more dollars to me. All they had thought about was the number they saw and did not do self-reflection of their own.

I hope that continuing my time in honors can help me learn from all my experiences in life this way and not take them for granted. This can help me grow to achieve some of my personal goals, like running a marathon in two months. I can take time to reflect after each individual run on how to improve. I also hope to grow professionally in this aspect to help me chase some of my career goals. I envision myself using this aspect of honors in almost every area of my life to continue to become the best version of myself I can be. This is super important to me in my spiritual life as well, as that is something that drives me every day in life, and reflection is one of the key components to growing in faith, which I also learned after reflecting more after taking Honors 201.